and speak with her, but under the Lagerführer's strict orders, no one was allowed near the women from the East until they passed their health checks.

She returned to the factory, cleaning the rangefinders as they came across the assembly line. The windows were all open and when the machines grew quiet she listened for the blow of a whistle or the screech of wheels on metal rails—but all she heard was the rush of the river outside.

Jana gave her a curious look and pointed to the rangefinders passing her on the assembly line. Rose had fallen behind on the day's quota. It was impossible to concentrate. She'd spent so much effort arranging for André's transfer that she couldn't settle her mind and focus until she knew he was here. At least now she didn't have to worry about the Meister shouting or docking her pay—because of Reinhardt, he wouldn't dare to.

Finally, the shift ended. Rose went outside. It had begun to rain, so she hurried to the train station. The platform was empty. Even the soldiers guarding the tent were gone. Now the rain was falling hard. And as the drops drenched her clothing, a realization suddenly hit her: had Reinhardt played a trick on her?

She paused, her stomach churning with a mix of emotions. All this time, she'd thought she had some kind of agency with him. But maybe it was the other way around. Perhaps he enjoyed misleading her? If this was true, and he had no intention of transferring André to Glashütte, then André was still in danger. She thought of the newspaper headlines—the photographs of destroyed buildings, flames and tracer lights spinning through the sky following all the bombings. She needed to talk with Léa. Her sister would know.

Rose, drenched from the rain, entered the sick bay. Léa was talking with Josef, and as her rubber soles squeaked across the floor, they both turned to her.

"What happened?" Léa asked.

"André's still in Berlin." Rose tried to hold back tears. "Maybe—"

Léa shook her head and put an arm around Rose, steering her toward the back of the sick bay.

"Come to the office," she said.

Josef opened the door and Léa guided Rose inside. She heard the door close and then a voice.

"Rose. I'm here."